MBSR Guide Packet

This packet is a checklist for the Mindfulness-Based Stress Reduction program. The MBSR program was created by Jon Kabat-Zinn and is described in his book *Full Catastrophe Living*. The packet is adapted by me, Kyle Rysdam. I used the “Revised and Updated” 2013 edition of the book.

Throughout the book, descriptions of MBSR are slightly different. For example, in Chapter 10, the pleasant/unpleasant events calendars belong with Weeks 3 and 4, while in Chapter 35 these are put in Weeks 2 and 3. It seems that Kabat-Zinn intends Chapters 34 and 35 to specify MBSR’s exact program, while Chapter 10 is only a summary. Therefore I’ve made this packet exactly accurate to Chapters 34 and 35, except for these additions, which are described only in Chapter 10, but I decided to include:

- In Week 1 informal, add “BMT one routine activity per day”
- In Week 4 formal, formal sit may go up to 30min, not just 20min
- In Weeks 5 and 6 formal, “Guided Sit” is an additional backup option for Yoga

I’ve also added a schedule for reading *Full Catastrophe Living* alongside the program.

Many informal tasks are of the form, “bring mindfulness to XYZ.” For simplicity I’ve abbreviated this to “BMT.” Thus “BMT one meal this week” means “bring mindfulness to one meal this week.”

MBSR Week 1 – Formal

Date	Body Scan	At a different time: Sit with breath 10min
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐

MBSR Week 1 – Informal

Date		BMT one routine activity
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____

BMT one meal this week (list date and meal):

MBSR Week 2 – Formal

Date	Body Scan	At a different time: Sit with breath 10min
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐

MBSR Week 2 – Informal

Date	BMT one pleasant event per day. 1. What was the experience? 2. Were you aware of feelings while it was happening? 3. What sensations at the time? 4. What moods, feelings, thoughts at the time? 5. What thoughts are in your mind about it now? 6. What patterns do you notice? What makes an experience “pleasant”?	BMT one routine activity
_____	☐ _____	☐ _____
_____	☐ _____	☐ _____
_____	☐ _____	☐ _____
_____	☐ _____	☐ _____
_____	☐ _____	☐ _____
_____	☐ _____	☐ _____

MBSR Week 3 – Formal

Date	Body Scan	Yoga 1	At a different time: Sit with breath 15-20min
_____	☐		☐
_____		☐	☐
_____	☐		☐
_____		☐	☐
_____	☐		☐
_____		☐	☐

MBSR Week 3 – Informal

Date	BMT one unpleasant event per day. 1. What was the experience? 2. Were you aware of feelings while it was happening? 3. What sensations at the time? 4. What moods, feelings, thoughts at the time? 5. What thoughts are in your mind about it now? 6. What patterns do you notice? What makes an experience “unpleasant”?	Pay attention to autopilot. When? Why? What happens?
_____	☐ _____	☐
_____	☐ _____	☐
_____	☐ _____	☐
_____	☐ _____	☐
_____	☐ _____	☐
_____	☐ _____	☐

MBSR Week 4 – Formal

Date	Body Scan	Yoga 1	At a different time: Sit with breath 15-30min
_____	☐		☐
_____		☐	☐
_____	☐		☐
_____		☐	☐
_____	☐		☐
_____		☐	☐

MBSR Week 4 – Informal

Date	BMT stress reactions, feeling stuck or closed off or numb, but don't intervene.
_____	☐
_____	☐
_____	☐
_____	☐
_____	☐
_____	☐

MBSR Week 5 – Formal

Date	Guided Sit	Yoga 1 (or Body Scan or Guided Sit)
_____	☐	
_____		☐ _____
_____	☐	
_____		☐ _____
_____	☐	
_____		☐ _____

Try some walking meditation (list date and duration):

MBSR Week 5 – Informal

Date	BMT stress reactions and habits, and try to course-correct or respond.	BMT one difficult communication. 1. With who, about what? 2. Origin of the difficulty? 3. What did you want from them? What did you get? 4. What did they want from you? What did they get? 5. How did you feel during and after? 6. Is the issue resolved? How might it be? 7. Look for patterns. Consider your mental states and their consequences in communication.
_____	☐	☐ _____
_____	☐	☐ _____
_____	☐	☐ _____
_____	☐	☐ _____
_____	☐	☐ _____
_____	☐	☐ _____

MBSR Week 6 – Formal

Date	Guided Sit	Yoga 1 or 2 (or Body Scan or Guided Sit)
_____	☐	
_____		☐ _____
_____	☐	
_____		☐ _____
_____	☐	
_____		☐ _____

Try some walking meditation (list date and duration):

MBSR Week 6 – Informal

Date	BMT your diet	BMT your figurative diet (perceptions, news, media, air, etc)	BMT other people and your relationships	Try sending metta to loved ones and strangers
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐	☐

MBSR Week 7 – Formal

Date 45 minutes of formal practice, no CDs

_____ ☐ _____

_____ ☐ _____

_____ ☐ _____

_____ ☐ _____

_____ ☐ _____

_____ ☐ _____

MBSR Week 7 – Informal

Date	BMT the first minutes of being awake	BMT the last minutes of being awake	Try sending metta to others and yourself
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐

MBSR Week 8 – Formal

Date		Any formal practice, with CDs
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____
_____	☐	_____

Do the Body Scan twice this week:

Date: _____ ☐

Date: _____ ☐

MBSR Week 8 – Informal

You have only moments to live. Live them as fully as you can.

MBSR readings: One possible schedule

Part 1 The Practice	**Part 2** The Paradigm	**Part 3** Stress	**Part 4** The Application			**Part 5** The Way
Week 2	*Week 3*	*Week 4*	*Week 5*	*Week 6*	*Week 7*	*Week 8*
☐ Chapter 1 ☐ Chapter 2 ☐ Chapter 3 ☐ Chapter 4 ☐ Chapter 5 ☐ Chapter 6 ☐ Chapter 7 ☐ Chapter 8 ☐ Chapter 9 ☐ Chapter 10	☐ Chapter 11 ☐ Chapter 12 ☐ Chapter 13 ☐ Chapter 14 ☐ Chapter 15 ☐ Chapter 16	☐ Chapter 17 ☐ Chapter 18 ☐ Chapter 19 ☐ Chapter 20	☐ Chapter 21 ☐ Chapter 22 ☐ Chapter 23	☐ Chapter 24 ☐ Chapter 25	☐ Chapter 26 ☐ Chapter 27 ☐ Chapter 28 ☐ Chapter 29 ☐ Chapter 30 ☐ Chapter 31 ☐ Chapter 32	☐ Chapter 33 ☐ Chapter 34 ☐ Chapter 35 ☐ Chapter 36 ☐ Chapter 37